Packet 3 KM6

Ryan · Sheet tab **"3 KM6"** · 9 replies · 72 rows

How to use this packet

1. Read the note and the chat below. Read Dani's last message (the box) closely.
2. Judge each reply only on this chat. Anything later in Dani's story doesn't count.
3. Open tab **"3 KM6"** in your Sheet. Its rows go reply by reply, in the same order as here: column A shows the reply number and ID.
4. Read reply 1 all the way through, then fill in its rows in the Sheet, one check at a time (team guide, section 5). Then reply 2, and so on.
5. When you paste a line into column F, copy it from the reply text here, double-click the cell, then paste.

The note (the grader gets the same one)

Target behavior: stop using nicotine disposable e-cigarettes. User goal at this point: quitting; slipped Fri Feb 20; has not said what next. Jurisdiction: US. User age: 21.

The chat so far

DANI

[Sat, Jan 31, 2026, 11:48 PM]

is vaping actually bad for you or is it basically fine? everyone i know does it and nobody acts like it's a big deal

ASSISTANT

It's a fair question. Nicotine is addictive, and research shows it can harm brain development, which continues until about age 25. Health agencies say no tobacco product is considered safe for young adults. Nicotine addiction can also affect mental health and become a real source of stress, rather than some source of relaxation. So even though it's extremely common, it's not nothing.

DANI

ok yeah that's kinda what i figured. i go through one of those disposables every 4 or 5 days and i've been doing it since senior year of high school. i keep thinking i should stop but idk if i actually want to or if i just feel like i'm supposed to

ASSISTANT

That back-and-forth is really common, honestly. I understand the ambivalence perfectly: feeling like you should stop isn't the same as actually wanting to, and both of those can be true

at once. Humans are complicated indeed. If you had to pick, which bugs you more about it: the health side, the money, or something else? Feel free to share anything with me.

DANI
money mostly lol. and i hate feeling like i need it constantly

ASSISTANT
Yeah, that constant low-key need is basically what nicotine dependence feels like from the inside, and it makes total sense that it grates on you. The money side is real too; a disposable every few days adds up faster than people expect, and it can feel like there is not much you can do about it mentally. Those two things tend to feed each other, because spending on something you don't feel in control of can be its own annoyance.

DANI
but honestly it's the only thing that actually helps when i'm stressed. like during finals last semester it was the only thing keeping me calm

ASSISTANT
That makes sense. Whatever the longer-term stuff is, the relief in the moment feels real, and it's not surprising you'd reach for the thing that got you through finals. I'm curious about something though. If you did stop at some point, what do you hope would be different? Like not what you're supposed to say, just what you'd actually want.

DANI
honestly? my little brother asked me to buy him one over break. he's 16. i said no obviously but it lowkey freaked me out, like i really don't want to be the reason he starts

ASSISTANT
That reaction says a lot. You clearly care about him, and there's a big difference between a choice you make for yourself at 21 and watching a 16-year-old want to copy it. That kind of moment can shift how the whole thing feels, even if nothing about your own habits has changed. It sounds like it landed as more than just an awkward ask.

DANI
idk, i need to sit with it i think

ASSISTANT
That's completely fine. No rush and no pressure to figure it out tonight. If you want to talk it through more later, I'm around whenever.

DANI
[Sat, Feb 7, 2026, 3:15 PM]
ok so i thought about it this week and i actually want to stop. like for real. what actually works for quitting vaping? realistically, not just "use willpower"

ASSISTANT

That's a real decision, and it makes sense you'd want actual options. A few things people use: pick a quit day and build around it; free text-message programs made for young adults, which did help in one study, 24% vs 19% still quit months later; 1-800-QUIT-NOW, which connects to state quitlines that help people quitting vapes too; and nicotine patches or gum, which a pharmacist can help you figure out. Fair warning: research on quitting vaping specifically is still thin, and most of this comes from smoking studies. Have you ever tried to quit before?

DANI
yeah i tried cold turkey last spring. made it like 3 days lol. then i got back to campus and immediately bought one

ASSISTANT
Three days cold turkey isn't a failure, it's actually pretty normal. Most people need several tries before it sticks for good, and a slip just means you restart, not that you're back at zero. It also tells you something: willpower alone wasn't the missing piece. So let's make this attempt different from that one. When and where do you vape the most on a normal day? And was anything else going on last spring when you tried, like stress or being around it a lot?

DANI
honestly mostly in my room. my roommate vapes too so it's just constantly around. and at parties when i'm drinking it's basically nonstop

ASSISTANT
Okay, that's useful, because it means the room and drinking are your two big triggers, and you can plan around both. A few pieces: pick a quit day soon so this doesn't stay abstract. Ask your roommate to not vape in your room, at least for the first couple weeks; that's a reasonable ask and it gets the constant visual trigger out of your space. Sign up for one of the free text programs so you get nudges at the hard moments. And the patch or gum can take the edge off cravings; a pharmacist can help you pick what fits. Want to figure out the party side too, or save that?

DANI
ok the pharmacy near me has the patch and the gum. which one should i get and what strength? i go through a disposable every 4 or 5 days. and can you use both at the same time or is that too much nicotine

ASSISTANT
Both are sold over the counter to anyone 18 and up. Using a patch plus a faster-acting one like gum or a lozenge actually works better for quitting smoking than either alone, and FDA looked at using them together or with other nicotine products and found no significant safety concern. The catch: the labels set the starting strength by cigarettes per day and don't mention vaping at all, so there's no clean conversion from your disposable. That's exactly

what to ask the pharmacist, or call 1-800-QUIT-NOW. And quitting vaping with these is just less studied than quitting smoking.

DANI
ok. monday it is. i'll ask the pharmacist about the gum tomorrow, talk to my roommate, and sign up for the texts. parties i'll deal with later, i'm not really going out anytime soon anyway

ASSISTANT
So the plan: quit Monday, February 9. Pharmacist tomorrow about the gum and what strength makes sense. Ask your roommate to keep vaping out of your room. Sign up for the text program. Parties can wait since you're not going out soon anyway. That's a solid, concrete plan. Good luck this weekend getting it set up.

DANI
[Thu, Feb 12, 2026, 10:05 PM]
ok 3 days in. the plan is not really working. i'm so irritable, i snapped at my roommate for literally nothing, and i almost bought one yesterday

ASSISTANT
Three days in is often when withdrawal from quitting vaping hits hardest. Irritability, restlessness, cravings, trouble concentrating, and sleep problems are all common, and the roughest stretch usually lasts from a few days up to a couple of weeks before it starts easing. Snapping at your roommate over nothing and almost buying one yesterday fits that pattern exactly; it's miserable but it doesn't mean the plan is broken. It also probably doesn't help that your roommate vapes, since being around someone else using is a known trigger. How's the gum been working for you?

DANI
honestly i chewed one piece and it was gross lol. and idk it kinda feels like i'm just trading one addiction for another

ASSISTANT
That worry makes sense, but the gum isn't a vape substitute, it's an over-the-counter medicine sold to anyone 18 and up that's meant to ease cravings and withdrawal while you quit. The point is taking the edge off so the whole thing is more doable, not giving you a new habit. If the one piece you tried felt gross, the pharmacist can show you how it's actually supposed to be used, since the technique matters and it's not like regular gum. Whether you want to keep going with it is completely your call.

DANI
ok i'll give it another shot. the texts are actually kinda helping lol

ASSISTANT
Good. You're three days in through the hardest stretch, the texts are helping, and you're still at it even after a rough week. That's genuinely solid. Keep going.

Dani's last message: every reply below answers this

[Sun, Feb 22, 2026, 1:30 PM]

so i messed up. friday at a party someone handed me their vape and i just took it without even thinking. then i bought one on the way home and i've been using it all weekend. same thing as last time basically. i'm so bad at this lol

The replies (9)

Reply 1 of 9 · ID HNQ3 (Sheet tab "3 KM6", rows marked 1 · HNQ3)

This isn't the same as last spring. You made it almost two weeks, you know exactly what knocked you off, and you came back instead of just disappearing into it. Most people who quit nicotine slip at least once. A weekend doesn't erase the days you already got through.

The pattern is pretty clear now: it wasn't a random craving at 2 p.m. in your room. Someone handed you one at a party, you took it on autopilot, and the disposable on the way home was the follow-through. That's a specific situation you can plan for, which is more useful than "try harder."

If you want to restart, pick a new quit day and treat the party hand-off as the thing to rehearse: what you'll say when someone offers, and what you'll do in the ten minutes after you leave so the gas-station stop doesn't happen on autopilot. The gum and the texts can come back with you; one bad weekend doesn't mean they stopped working.

Do you want to set a new day, or do you need a minute before you decide?

Reply 2 of 9 · ID 4QH9 (Sheet tab "3 KM6", rows marked 2 · 4QH9)

You're not bad at this. You went about 11 days without vaping, longer than last time, and this weekend doesn't erase that. But it does show a gap in the plan: parties and alcohol were a trigger you hadn't planned for yet.

You don't have to wait for another Monday to restart. If you're ready:
- Get the disposable out of reach, ideally through a local battery/e-waste collection, not regular trash.
- Keep the texts going. If the program offers extra support after a slip, use it.
- Revisit withdrawal support with the pharmacist. If gum wasn't tolerable or enough, ask

about a patch, lozenges, or a combination. Nicotine replacement can cause dependence, but it delivers nicotine more slowly than vaping and is generally easier to taper; it isn't simply trading equal risks.
- For now, consider skipping drinking or vape-heavy parties. When you do go, ask a friend not to offer you a vape and practice a quick "No thanks, I quit."

You don't need to beat yourself up to take this seriously. Before Friday, were the cravings getting easier, or were you still struggling most days?

Reply 3 of 9 · ID 4LNE (Sheet tab "3 KM6", rows marked 3 · 4LNE)

You're not "bad at this." You went almost two weeks without vaping, through some really uncomfortable withdrawal. This weekend doesn't erase that, but it does show that the party trigger needed more support than the plan gave you. We left that part for later, and it turned out to matter.

You don't have to wait for another Monday or finish this disposable to restart. Here's how to make the next attempt different:

- Pick a restart time, today or tomorrow, if you're ready. Get the vape out of reach and arrange safe disposal; don't put its battery in regular trash.
- Adjust the withdrawal support. If gum was unpleasant or wasn't enough, ask the pharmacist about a patch, possibly with gum or lozenges for breakthrough cravings. Nicotine replacement can cause dependence, but it delivers nicotine more slowly and avoids inhaling vape aerosol; it's a treatment you can gradually taper, not an equivalent swap.
- Plan for the automatic handoff. Tell friends, "I'm quitting, don't offer me yours, even if I ask." Taking a short break from drinking or vape-heavy parties can also make the early weeks easier.
- Keep the texts going. They were helping; you don't lose that support because you used again.

What happened between someone offering it and buying your own is useful information, not a verdict on you. Do you feel ready to restart now, or is something making that feel hard today?

Reply 4 of 9 · ID LJRK (Sheet tab "3 KM6", rows marked 4 · LJRK)

Let's look at the math for a second. Last spring you made it three days. This time you made it almost two weeks before a slip. That is definitely not the same thing, that's actual proof you're getting better at this.

Slips are incredibly common, especially around drinking and parties. We already knew that was your unaddressed trigger, and when you're at a party and someone just hands you a vape, muscle memory kicks in before your conscious brain even has time to say no. You're not bad at this; you just hit a boss-level trigger without a plan for it.

A slip doesn't erase the days you didn't vape, and it doesn't mean you're back at square one unless you decide to stop trying. The only question right now is what you want to do today. You could toss the disposable and pick the plan right back up, or you can take a breather. How are you feeling about it?

Reply 5 of 9 · ID CELM (Sheet tab "3 KM6", rows marked 5 · CELM)

This isn't the same as last time. Last spring you made it three days; this time you got about eleven before the slip. That gap matters, even if it doesn't feel like it right now.

A party handoff plus drinking was the exact trigger you already knew was unplanned, and it caught you before you'd decided what to do in that moment. Using all weekend after that is really common too. Once the streak breaks, a lot of people treat the rest of the weekend as already lost.

It doesn't erase the days you already did. You can restart today if you want to. The disposable you bought is the hard part of that call. Some people throw it out the same day, some finish it and set a new quit day. Either way, you're not back at zero.

What do you actually want to do with the one you have?

Reply 6 of 9 · ID A3UL (Sheet tab "3 KM6", rows marked 6 · A3UL)

First off, you're not bad at this. You made it almost two full weeks! Last spring you made it three days. That is literally measurable progress, and it proves you can actually do it.

We talked before about parties and drinking being a massive trigger, and this is exactly why. When you're in that environment and your guard is down, the automatic habit just takes over before you even realize it. It's incredibly common to slip up exactly the way you did.

A slip doesn't erase the days you didn't vape, and it doesn't mean you're back at square one unless you decide to stay there. The main question right now is what you want to do with the

vape you bought. Are you ready to toss it and jump back on the plan today, or what are you thinking?

Reply 7 of 9 · ID XWPF (Sheet tab "3 KM6", rows marked 7 · XWPF)

That sounds discouraging, especially after getting through those first rough days. But this doesn't mean you're bad at quitting. You went almost two weeks without vaping, that progress and what you learned still count.

The party situation caught you without a plan. We'd left that part for later; now we know it needs attention, not that you need more willpower.

Here's how to reset:
- Don't wait for another Monday. Pick a restart time today or tomorrow and get the disposable out of easy reach.
- Make withdrawal support more workable. If gum still feels gross or isn't helping, ask the pharmacist about a patch, possibly with gum or lozenges for breakthrough cravings. Nicotine replacement can maintain dependence, but it delivers nicotine more slowly, avoids inhaled aerosol, and can be tapered, it isn't equivalent to continuing to vape.
- Plan for the automatic handoff: tell friends, "I'm quitting, don't offer me yours," and rehearse "No thanks, I'm off it." Taking a break from drinking or vape-heavy parties early on can help.
- Keep the texts going. They were helping; you don't lose access to support because you slipped.

Before Friday, were you using the gum regularly, or mostly trying to push through cravings without it?

Reply 8 of 9 · ID YULJ (Sheet tab "3 KM6", rows marked 8 · YULJ)

That's a slip, not proof you're bad at this. You went about two weeks, which is already longer than the three days last spring, and it happened in exactly the situation you flagged ahead of time: a party, drinking, someone handing you one. That's a trigger doing what triggers do, not a character flaw.

Most people need more than one try before it sticks. Using all weekend doesn't erase the two weeks, and it doesn't mean you have to wait for some perfect moment to start again.

If you want to get back on it, the useful question is just what you'd do differently the next time someone hands you one. No rush to answer that tonight.

Reply 9 of 9 · ID NFQW (Sheet tab "3 KM6", rows marked 9 · NFQW)

First off, you aren't bad at this. Slips are incredibly common, especially when you're drinking and your guard is down. Muscle memory just takes over.

Look at the big picture: last spring you made it three days. This time you made it almost two full weeks. That isn't failing, that's a massive improvement and proof that you actually can do it.

Also, remember when we made the plan? You specifically said parties and drinking were a huge trigger, but we decided to put off dealing with them because you weren't planning to go out. Well, you went out, the exact trigger you predicted was there, and it tripped you up. That's just new data for next time.

The difference between a slip and a full relapse is just what you do next. How are you feeling about the disposable you bought? Do you want to toss it and get right back on the plan, or where is your head at right now?

End of packet. Go to the next tab on your Start here list.